I William, king, the third of my reign,
Give to Paulyn Rawdon, Hope and Hopetowne,
With all the bounds both up and downe,
From heaven to yerthe, from yerthe to hel,
For thee and thyne there to dwell.
As truly as this kingright is mine,
For a crossbow and an arrow.
When I sal come to hunt on yarrow;
And in token that this thing is sooth,
I bit the whyt wax with my tooth,
Before Meg, Mawd, and Margery,
And my third son Henry.[14]

Ashoka is supposed to have died after sealing the document containing his donation. It was said that eventually a new king could only succeed Ashoka after the whole earth had been bought back by the ministers of the Maurya court, who agreed to give four kotis of gold pieces to complete Ashoka's shortfall.

The end is poignant, dramatic, and ironic all at once. His dying words emphasize that his last act was not to seek the rewards of rebirth or the glories of kingship but mastery over the mind: 'because I give it with faith, I would obtain as the fruit of this gift something that cannot be stolen, that is honoured by the aryas and safe from all agitation: sovereignty of the mind.'

With his last breath, the emperor sacrifices an entire empire—the empire that he had once so fiercely usurped.